AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Sentinel Ops

Blue Team, SOC & DFIR Tools

48	224,779	98%	43
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

48 tools · ← Back to the main list · Data verified **2026-10-22** (re-verified monthly)

CURATOR'S NOTES

Detect, hunt, forensicate — the defensive operations toolkit.

MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-10-22)

- **Active in the last 30 days:** 35 of 47 tracked GitHub repos (74%)
- **Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 509 curated free tools across 14 realms

FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	WHAT IT DOES
osquery	23.7k	2014	2026-10-22 ✅	SQL powered operating system instrumentation, monitoring, and analytics.
Wazuh	17.4k	2015	2026-10-22 ✅	Wazuh - The Open Source Security Platform. Unified XDR and SIEM protection for endpoints and cloud workloads.
Atomic Red Team	12.7k	2017	2026-10-21 ✅	Small and highly portable detection tests based on MITRE's ATT&CK.
Sigma	11.3k	2016	2026-10-21 ✅	Main Sigma Rule Repository
awesome-honeypots	10.6k	2015	2026-06-01	an awesome list of honeypot resources
YARA	10k	2012	2026-10-21 ✅	The pattern matching swiss knife

Full Inventory — 48 curated tools

ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-10-22 census · non-GitHub entries listed last

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
osquery	23.7k	2014	2026-10-22 ✅	— operate endpoints as a SQL database: ask security questions, get rows back. Used by IT-security teams querying endpoints with SQL; the open-source foundation Facebook built for fleet visibility.
Wazuh	17.4k	2015	2026-10-22 ✅	— open-source XDR/SIEM: FIM, log analysis, vulnerability detection and compliance reporting in one free platform. Used by SOC teams running open XDR and SIEM; the free alternative to Splunk, QRadar and commercial EDR stacks. (GPL-2.0)
Atomic Red Team	12.7k	2017	2026-10-21 ✅	— library of executable detection tests mapped to MITRE ATT&CK; prove your defenses fire. Used by purple teams testing detections per ATT&CK technique; the open-source alternative to commercial breach-attack-simulation platforms.
Sigma	11.3k	2016	2026-10-21 ✅	— vendor-neutral SIEM detection rules — "Snort for logs", convertible to Splunk/Sentinel/Elastic. Used by detection engineers writing portable detection rules; the vendor-neutral alternative to proprietary SIEM rule languages. (DRL 1.1 rules)
awesome-honeypots	10.6k	2015	2026-06-01	— the curated honeypot directory: deception tech from low to high interaction. Used by deception researchers picking deployable honeypots. (curated list)
YARA	10k	2012	2026-10-21 ✅	— the pattern-matching language for malware identification — if you write detections, you write YARA. Used by malware analysts everywhere to classify samples; the pattern-matching standard commercial AV also uses. (BSD-3)
Awesome Incident Response	9.5k	2015	2026-10-13 ✅	— the curated IR toolkit index used across the industry. Used by DFIR professionals assembling their toolkit. (Apache-2.0, curated list)
ntopng	8.3k	2015	2026-10-21 ✅	— high-speed web-based traffic monitoring: flows, top talkers and protocols with long historical views. Used by network engineers observing traffic in real time; the open-source traffic-analysis alternative to commercial NPM tools. (GPL-3.0)
Zeek	8.1k	2012	2026-10-22 ✅	— the network analysis framework that turns raw traffic into structured, queryable intelligence. Used by NSM teams producing rich network telemetry; the framework most SOC pipelines are built around. (BSD-3)
Arkime	7.5k	2012	2026-10-22 ✅	— full-packet capture plus indexed search at scale (formerly Moloch); PCAP you can actually query. Used by NSM teams capturing and searching full packets at scale; the open-source alternative to commercial full-packet-capture appliances.
Suricata	6.8k	2012	2026-10-20 ✅	— high-performance IDS/IPS/NSM engine with full protocol logging and Eve JSON output. Used by network defenders running IDS/IPS at line rate; the open-source engine behind countless commercial and gov deployments. (GPL-2.0)
capa	6.3k	2020	2026-10-21 ✅	— identifies what malware actually does: maps capabilities and ATT&CK techniques straight from binaries. Used by malware analysts determining what binaries can do; the open-source capability engine from Mandiant research.
pspy	6.2k	2018	2026-03-01	— watch process and file events on any Linux box without root — catch cron-based persistence in the act. Used by pentesters and CTF players watching process activity without root; the standard privesc enumeration tool. (GPL-3.0)
sysmon-config	5.7k	2017	2024-07-03 ⏳	— the battle-tested Sysmon configuration behind thousands of SOC detections; the de-facto starting point for Windows telemetry. Used by blue teams deploying hardened Windows logging; the widely-adopted SwiftOnSecurity baseline.
ThreatMapper	5.3k	2020	2026-06-01	— Deepfence's open runtime threat scanner: finds and ranks exploitable vulnerabilities in cloud and container workloads. Used by cloud security teams mapping runtime risks; Deepfence's open-source alternative to commercial CNAPPs.
Security Onion	4.9k	2018	2026-10-19 ✅	— the free SOC-in-a-box distro: Suricata, Zeek, Elastic, dashboards and detection pipelines. Used by SOC and DFIR teams as a complete network-security-monitoring distro; the free alternative to commercial NSM suites. (Elastic License 2.0)
Threat Hunter Playbook	4.7k	2017	2026-01-12	— open hunting playbooks as code: hypotheses mapped to data sources and detections. Used by threat hunters learning detection strategy; the open knowledge base for hunting methodology. (MIT)

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Volatility 3	4.5k	2014	2026-10-12 ✅	— memory forensics framework — RAM malware has nowhere to hide. Used by DFIR analysts extracting artifacts from memory images; the framework that defined open memory forensics.
Velociraptor	4.4k	2018	2026-10-22 ✅	— endpoint visibility and DFIR at scale: hunt across thousands of machines with one query language. Used by DFIR teams hunting across thousands of endpoints; the open-source alternative to commercial endpoint-forensics platforms. (AGPL-3.0)
Awesome YARA	4.3k	2017	2026-06-15	— curated YARA rules, tooling and research for malware hunting. Used by malware analysts collecting detection rules. (CC-BY-4.0, curated list)
HELK	3.9k	2017	2024-06-01 ⏳	— the Hunting ELK: a pre-built Elasticsearch/Kafka/Spark lab for threat-hunting research — a research project with low churn. Used by threat-hunting learners standing up an ELK hunting lab; the open-source project for detection-engineering practice. (GPL-3.0)
CAPEv2	3.6k	2019	2026-10-20 ✅	— the maintained Cuckoo sandbox: automated malware detonation, config extraction and reporting. Used by malware analysts running automated sandbox detonations; the open-source alternative to commercial sandboxes like JoeSandbox. (GPL-3.0)
Snort 3	3.4k	2014	2026-10-21 ✅	— the next generation of the classic open-source IDS/IPS, rewritten in C++ with multi-threading. Used by network defenders running the classic open IDS; the engine that defined open-source intrusion detection. (GPL-2.0)
Timesketch	3.4k	2014	2026-10-20 ✅	— Google's collaborative forensic timeline analysis for multi-investigator cases. Used by DFIR analysts building collaborative forensic timelines; the open-source alternative to commercial timeline-analysis tools.
The Sleuth Kit	3.2k	2011	2026-10-20 ✅	— the forensic library behind half the DFIR tools you know: disks, filesystems and timelines. Used by DFIR analysts examining disk images and file systems; the open-source foundation under commercial forensic suites. (CPL-1.0)
sysmon-modular	3.2k	2018	2026-10-14 ✅	— Swiss-army Sysmon configuration: per-ATT&CK-technique logging modules you compose yourself. Used by detection engineers tailoring Sysmon per event type; the community config alternative to fixed baselines.
Elastic detection-rules	2.9k	2020	2026-10-22 ✅	— the detection corpus for Elastic Security: hundreds of maintained rules mapped to MITRE. Used by SOC teams deploying detection content; the open-source ruleset behind Elastic Security. (Elastic-2.0)
Fibratus	2.6k	2016	2026-10-19 ✅	— Windows kernel-event tracing with YARA filtering; a Swiss army knife for endpoint visibility. Used by defenders tracing Windows kernel activity for threats; the open-source kernel-observability tool. (Apache-2.0)
Shuffle	2.5k	2020	2026-10-20 ✅	— self-hosted SOAR automation: connect your TIP, SIEM and responders in drag-and-drop workflows. Used by SOC teams automating playbooks; the open-source SOAR alternative to Splunk SOAR and XSOAR. (AGPL-3.0)
DeepBlueCLI	2.4k	2016	2023-10-14 ⏳	— SANS blue-team PowerShell for fast Windows event-log hunting: logons, mutants, suspicious service installs — quiet upstream but still a blue-team staple. Used by defenders triaging Windows event logs quickly; the free PowerShell tool for fast log review. (GPL-3.0)
Kismet	2.2k	2016	2026-10-21 ✅	— passive wireless detection layer: discovers Wi-Fi and BLE devices, rogue access points and wardrives. Used by wireless security auditors monitoring WiFi and Bluetooth; the standard open wireless detection platform. (GPL-2.0)
Sysmon for Linux	2.2k	2020	2026-10-16 ✅	— the Windows-trusted system monitor ported to Linux. Used by defenders unifying endpoint telemetry across OSes; Microsoft's cross-platform extension of Sysmon. (MIT)
Nagios Core	2.1k	2014	2026-08-07	— the classic infrastructure monitor: availability checks that surface outages and anomalies early. Used by ops teams monitoring infrastructure for decades; the classic open-source monitoring platform. (GPL-2.0)
FIR	2k	2015	2026-09-14	— Fast Incident Response from Société Générale: ticketing built for IR workflows. Used by incident-response teams managing cases; the open-source IR platform for teams without commercial case tools. (GPL-3.0)
msticpy	2k	2019	2026-10-19 ✅	— SecOps analysis library from Microsoft: pivots, timelines and hunting helpers for Jupyter. Used by defenders hunting in Microsoft 365 and Sentinel data; Microsoft's open hunting library. (MIT)

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Netcap	1.8k	2018	2026-10-21 ✅	— security audit framework over network traffic: sensors, audit and collection from live or captured streams. Used by researchers analyzing network captures as structured data; the open-source framework for network-audit work. (GPL-3.0)
go-audit	1.7k	2016	2026-10-21 ✅	— auditd in JSON for Linux: structured events that pipelines can actually parse. Used by defenders replacing auditd for reliable Linux auditing; the open-source audit daemon for scale. (MIT)
Conpot	1.5k	2013	2026-10-20 ✅	— ICS/SCADA honeypot: emulates the protocols that run factories, safely. Used by researchers deploying ICS/SCADA honeypots; the open-source deception tool for industrial protocols. (GPL-2.0)
NoScript	1.2k	2018	2026-10-05 ✅	— the browser extension that blocks JavaScript and plugin content by default — client-side hardening's origin story. Used by privacy-focused users blocking scripts by default; the long-standing open-source browser-hardening extension. (GPL-3.0)
ElastAlert2	1.1k	2020	2026-10-20 ✅	— the maintained successor to ElastAlert: flexible alerting on Elasticsearch data with dozens of rule types. Used by SOC teams alerting from Elasticsearch data; the open-source alerting layer for ELK stacks.
HijackThis	817	2016	2026-07-02	— the veteran Windows hijack analyzer: scans browser and OS settings for malicious tampering. Used by technicians diagnosing Windows malware persistence; the veteran free scanner still trusted for autostart analysis. (GPL-2.0)
Krawl	785	2025	2026-10-17 ✅	— deception-driven defense: a honeypot server framework for research. Used by defenders discovering and inventorying web assets; the open-source exposure-mapping crawler. (MIT)
Revoke-Obfuscation	755	2017	2023-12-01 ⏳	— Daniel Bohannon's framework for detecting obfuscated PowerShell at scale; quiet upstream, still the reference. Used by DFIR analysts decoding obfuscated PowerShell; the open-source framework for deobfuscation work.
RITA	663	2024	2026-10-15 ✅	— detects C2 beaconing in Zeek logs — traffic analysis that finds the quiet intruders. Used by threat hunters finding C2 beaconing in DNS and flows; the free open-source hunter for network telemetry. (GPL-3.0)
Sublime Rules	380	2021	2026-10-22 ✅	— the community rule corpus for the Sublime platform. Used by email defenders detecting phishing patterns; the open detection ruleset for the Sublime platform. (MIT)
Sublime Platform	277	2021	2026-10-21 ✅	— open email threat detection: rules-as-code against phishing and BEC. Used by email-security teams defending mail flows; the open-source email-defense platform alternative to commercial email gateways. (MIT)
logarc	1	2026	2026-10-21 ✅	— offline access-log forensics that reconstructs attacker activity graphs. Used by incident responders analyzing web logs without cloud tooling; the offline log-forensics analyzer. (MIT)
Sysinternals Suite	—	—	—	— Microsoft's free Windows admin and DFIR toolkit: Process Explorer, Autoruns, Procmon and dozens more. Used by every Windows admin and IR analyst; Microsoft's free toolkit commercial IR teams also rely on. (free, proprietary)